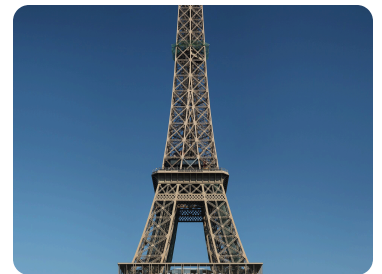




🇫🇷 Day 12 · Sunday, Aug 30 · PARIS — VERSAILLES + LOUVRE

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



You: solo · **pure vegetarian** (no meat, no fish, no seafood) **Base:** St Christopher's Paris — Gare du Nord (5 Rue de Dunkerque) **Veg phrase:** *"Je suis végétarien strict, sans viande, sans poisson, sans fruits de mer."* **Headline:** The two heavyweight interiors in one day — **Versailles 10:00** ✅ in the morning, **Louvre 15:00** ✅ in the afternoon, then Arc de Triomphe rooftop for the sunset and the 10 PM sparkle.

⚠️ **This is the single biggest WALKING day of the whole trip.** Two vast interiors + Champs-Élysées. Wear your most broken-in shoes, carry a water bottle, pace your feet. 70–80% is a win.

Why today works (all three are OPEN on a Sunday): Orsay is closed Mondays (done Aug 29) · **Versailles is closed Mondays** · **Louvre is closed Tuesdays** (you leave Tue morning). Aug 30 is **Sunday** — everything is open. This ordering is deliberate; keep it.

🕒 **WAKE & LEAVE**

- **07:15** — Wake, quick breakfast at/near the hostel (croissant + coffee; there's a café-bar). Eat something real — veg is scarce at Versailles.
- **08:00** — **Leave the hostel.** Metro down to an RER C stop, then RER C out. Budget **~45 min** door-to-gate. Leaving at 08:00 gives a comfortable cushion for the **10:00 slot**.
- Target: **at the Château security line by ~09:15–09:30**, before the 10:00 rush.

GETTING TO VERSAILLES (read this — the ticket is different)

- **Line: RER C** toward "**Versailles Château – Rive Gauche**" (this exact station — NOT Versailles-Chantiers, NOT Rive Droite). Rive Gauche is a flat ~10-min walk to the palace gates.
- From Gare du Nord: metro to an RER C stop (e.g. **Saint-Michel–Notre-Dame** or **Invalides**), then RER C outbound. Let your maps app pick the live fastest route.
- **⚠ Ticket: Versailles is Zone 4.** Buy a dedicated "**Paris ↔ Versailles Château**" **RER C ticket (~€4.50 each way)** at the machine — a **standard t+ metro ticket does NOT reach Versailles** and you'll be fined. Keep the paper ticket to tap out at Versailles.
- Journey: **~40–45 min** each way.

HOURLY-BY-HOURLY (real, buffered times)

Time	What	Notes
07:15	Wake, breakfast near hostel	Eat properly — veg is scarce at Versailles
08:00	Leave hostel → metro → RER C (Zone-4 ticket!)	~45 min to Versailles
09:15–09:30	Arrive Château – Rive Gauche, walk to gates, security	Beat the 10:00 rush
10:00	 PALACE OF VERSAILLES  booked — QR ready	Scan QR at Entrance A. ~30-min grace (09:45–10:30 fine); don't arrive <i>before</i> 10:00 expecting early entry.
10:00–12:30	State Apartments → Hall of Mirrors → King's & Queen's chambers	~2.5 hrs. Grab the free official audioguide. Skip the far gardens/Trianon.
12:30	Quick near-garden view / Latona parterre from the terrace	Fountains may run on Sundays
13:00	RER C back toward Paris	~45 min
~13:50	 Veg lunch (Little India / central)	Unhurried — you've earned it. See food.
14:45	Walk to the Louvre Carrousel entrance	Skip the glass-Pyramid queue
15:00	 THE LOUVRE  booked — QR ready	Scan QR at the Carrousel. ~30-min grace (14:45–15:30 fine).

Time	What	Notes
15:00	Mona Lisa FIRST (Denon wing, Salle des États)	Go straight there before the afternoon crowd peaks
15:20–17:15	Venus de Milo · Winged Victory · medieval moat · Napoleon III Apartments	~2 hrs greatest-hits — leave when your brain is done
17:15	☕ Exit → rest in the Tuileries Garden , water/café	Feet break before the Arc
17:45	Stroll Champs-Élysées toward the Arc	~1.5 km, or Metro Line 1
18:15	🏛️ Arc de Triomphe rooftop (buy on-site ~€16)	Golden hour; sunset ~20:20. Use the underground passage — never cross the traffic circle on foot.
19:30	🍽️ Dinner — Little India (Krishna / Saravana Bhavan)	Rue du Faubourg Saint-Denis
21:00–22:00	Back to the Arc rooftop or Trocadéro for the 10 PM sparkle ✨	The sparkle from the Arc terrace is unreal
~22:30	Metro back to hostel, rest	Tomorrow is the lighter chill day

TICKETS

- **Versailles — 10:00** ✅ **booked — QR ready.** Scan at Entrance A. ~30-min grace. Download the QR offline the night before. Free audioguide included.
- **Louvre — 15:00** ✅ **booked — QR ready. Enter via the CARROUSEL DU LOUVRE** underground entrance, NOT the main glass Pyramid — far shorter line. ~30-min grace. **Mona Lisa first**, then loop the icons on the way out.
- **Arc de Triomphe (~€16) — buy on-site day-of.** Not pre-booked, no need. Rooftop = the best night vantage for the Eiffel sparkle.
- 📄 Download **both** QR codes offline the night before.

★ WHAT TO SEE + WHY

- **Hall of Mirrors (Galerie des Glaces):** 73 m of mirrored arcades where the 1919 Treaty of Versailles was signed — the most iconic room in France. Go slow; best light mid-morning.
- **Mona Lisa:** smaller than you expect, behind glass, always mobbed — that's why you hit her first, snap it, move on.
- **Winged Victory of Samothrace:** on the Daru staircase — arguably more breathtaking than the Mona Lisa. Don't miss it.
- **Venus de Milo:** Sully wing, ground floor, Greek antiquities.

- 💎 **Medieval Louvre / the moat:** basement (Sully) — the original 12th-c. fortress foundations. Quiet, atmospheric, most tourists skip it.

VEGETARIAN FOOD

- ⚠️ **L'As du Fallafel (Marais)** reopens after Shabbat, but it's off your route today — the Little India spots below are the plan.
- 🍷 **Little India — Krishna Bhavan / Saravana Bhavan** (Rue du Faubourg Saint-Denis / Passage Brady, near your hostel line) — **pure-veg South Indian:** masala dosa, idli-vada-sambar, thali, uttapam, paneer curries, filter coffee. Familiar, filling fuel before the Louvre and again for dinner.
- Quick central alt near the Louvre: a **veg crêpe/galette** or a falafel wrap to save time.
- **Versailles note:** palace food is limited and pricey — carry a **snack + water bottle**, or eat well at breakfast and save the real meal for lunch back in Paris.
- **HappyCow** for the nearest all-veg anywhere.

TIPS

- 🧦 **Comfy, broken-in shoes are non-negotiable** — heaviest-walking day of the trip.
 - 🎫 **Buy the correct RER C Zone-4 ticket** for Versailles — a normal metro ticket won't reach it (fine risk).
 - 🕒 Both bookings have a **30-min grace window** — no panic if a train runs late.
 - 🖼️ **Mona Lisa first; Winged Victory is the sleeper highlight.**
 - ✨ **10 PM sparkle from the Arc rooftop** is the day's magic ending.
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Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

Today you walk straight into the most famous museum scene in cinema — and a palace that's its own movie set.

Hollywood / French

- **The Da Vinci Code (2006)** — THE big one for today. The film **opens inside the Louvre:** the murder in the **Grand Gallery**, the **Mona Lisa**, and the famous ending at the **glass Pyramid** (which hides the "Rose Line" mystery). You stand in all of it this afternoon — the Pyramid, the Denon wing, La Joconde herself.
- **Ratatouille (2007)** — Remy's Paris; the Tuileries + Seine skyline you rest in at 17:15 is pure Ratatouille.

- **Midnight in Paris (2011)** — Gil's nostalgic wander includes the Tuileries and the Right Bank you cross today.
- **Before Sunset (2004)** — the Left Bank stroll passes these same central quarters.
- **Inception (2010)** — the dream-Paris folds near the river; keep the surreal-city feeling as you cross the Tuileries.
- **Emily in Paris** — the Louvre Pyramid and the Champs-Élysées you walk this evening are recurring backdrops.

Bollywood — you'll love these

- **Befikre (2016, Ranveer Singh & Vaani Kapoor)** — shot **entirely in Paris**; the couple romp past the **Louvre**, the Tuileries, the Champs-Élysées and the **Arc de Triomphe** — your exact afternoon-into-evening route. Cue "*Ude Dil Befikre*" on the Champs walk.
- **Queen (2014, Kangana Ranaut)** — Rani's solo-honeymoon Paris; the museum-and-monument wandering mirrors your solo day among Versailles and the Louvre.
- **An Evening in Paris (1967, Shammi Kapoor & Sharmila Tagore)** — the classic Bollywood-in-Paris film; its landmark tour is your day.

VERSAILLES specifically

- **Marie Antoinette (2006, Sofia Coppola)** — filmed **on location at the Palace of Versailles**: the State Apartments, the **Hall of Mirrors**, the gardens. As you walk the mirrored gallery and the royal chambers this morning, you're inside Coppola's exact sets — the candy-colored, doomed-queen fairytale played out in these very rooms.

Today's soundtrack: "*Ude Dil Befikre*" for the Champs-Élysées stroll to the Arc. ✨